

CLAIMS (marked-up version)

1. A composition containing Opuntia Ficus Indica cladodes polysaccharides ~~and a further active substance~~, sodium bicarbonate, alginic acid or alginate salts and Olea Europea leaves extract, for use in the prevention and therapy of diseases of the upper gastrointestinal tract, said active substance being selected from omeprazole, lansoprazole, cimetidine, ranitidine, metoclopramide, domperidone, laevosulpiride, magnesium and aluminium hydroxide, sodium bicarbonate, alginic acid or alginate salts, chitosane, sucralfate, anti-inflammatory flavonoids extracted from Olea Europea or from Capparis Spinosa, anthocyanoside from red oranges or black rice, and wherein said diseases are selected from gastroesophageal reflux, GERD, dyspepsia, gastrointestinal disorders, pharyngitis, Barrett's esophagus, esophageal adenocarcinoma and GERD-related pulmonary symptoms.
2. A composition according to claim 1, wherein said cladodes polysaccharides are provided as mucilages, cladode juice or as a cladode juice-(ultra)filtered aqueous solution, which is optionally concentrated and dried.
3. A composition according to claims 1-2, wherein said cladodes polysaccharides are in amounts of from 0.5% to 50% by composition weight.
4. ~~A composition according to claims 1-3, wherein said active substance belongs to one of the following therapeutic classes: Proton Pump Inhibitors (PPIs), H₂ receptors antagonists, prokinetic agents, antacid agents, cytoprotecting agents, anti-inflammatory agents.~~
5. ~~A composition according to claim 4, wherein said active substance is selected from omeprazole, lansoprazole, cimetidine, ranitidine,~~

~~metoclopramide, domperidone, laevosulpiride, magnesium and aluminium hydroxide, sodium bicarbonate, alginic acid or alginate salts, chitosane, sucralfate, anti-inflammatory flavonoids extracted from Olea Europaea or from Capparis Spinosa, anthocyanoside from red oranges or black rice.~~

5 ~~6. A composition according to claims 1-3, further containing Olea Europaea leaves extract.~~

~~7.4. A composition according to claims 1-63, which is suitable for oral administration.~~

8 ~~5. A composition according to claim 7.4, which is in the form of pharmaceutical or nutraceutical preparation, health food or medical device composition.~~

9 ~~6. A composition according to claim 8.5, which is in the form of solution, suspension, emulsion, tablet, capsule, powder or bag for extemporary preparation of oral suspension or oral emulsion.~~

15 ~~7. A composition according to claims 1-6, further containing active substances known to prevent and cure the same diseases which are selected from antacid agents, proton pump inhibitors, H₂ antagonists, prokinetic agents, chitosanes, aluminum hydroxide, calcium or magnesium carbonate.~~

10 ~~8. A composition according to claims 1-97, which is selected from the group consisting of:~~

A)

Suspension	
Sodium Alginate	5-g

Sodium Bicarbonate	2.67 g
Opuntia Ficus Indica cladodes polysaccharides	2.0 g
Water	Up to 100 ml

B)

Powder	
Sodium Alginate	10 - 20 g
Sodium Bicarbonate	5 - 10 g
Opuntia Ficus Indica cladodes polysaccharides	1 - 20 g

C)

Powder	
Sodium Alginate	10 - 20 g
Sodium Bicarbonate	5 - 10 g
Olea Europeae leaves extract	5 - 20 g
Opuntia Ficus Indica cladodes polysaccharides	1 - 20 g

D)

Capsule	mg/capsule
Cimetidine	200 mg
Opuntia Ficus Indica cladodes polysaccharides	100–200 mg
Olea Europeae leaves extract	100–200 mg
Lactose	up to capsule filling

5 E)

Capsule	mg/capsule
Ranitidine hydrochloride	84 mg
Alginic Acid	500.0 mg
Opuntia Ficus Indica cladodes polysaccharides	200 mg
Olea Europeae leaves extract	200 mg
Sodium Bicarbonate	165.25 mg
Magnesium Stearate	0.75 mg
Filler	350 mg

- 44 9. A combined preparation containing *Opuntia Ficus Indica* cladodes polysaccharides, sodium bicarbonate, alginic acid or alginate salts and *Olea Europeae* leaves extract and ~~a further active ingredient selected from omeprazole, lansoprazole, cimetidine, ranitidine, metoclopramide,~~
- 5 ~~domperidone, laevosulpiride, magnesium and aluminium hydroxide, sodium bicarbonate, alginic acid or alginate salts, chitosane, sucralfate, anti-inflammatory flavonoids extracted from *Olea Europeae* or from *Capparis Spinosa*, anthocyanoside from red oranges or black rice,~~ for simultaneous or separate use in the prevention or treatment of a condition, disease or
- 10 dysfunction of the upper gastrointestinal tract, which is selected from gastroesophageal reflux, GERD, dyspepsia, gastrointestinal disturbs, pharyngitis, Barrett's esophagus, esophageal adenocarcinoma and GERD-related pulmonary symptoms.
- ~~12. A combined preparation according to claim 11, additionally containing~~
- 15 ~~*Olea Europeae* leaves extract.~~